Republic of the Philippines
Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
BANGSAMORO TRANSITION AUTHORITY PARLIAMENT
Bangsamoro Government Center, Cotabato City

THIRD REGULAR SESSION

PARLIAMENT RESOLUTION NO. 531

RESOLUTION STRONGLY CONDEMNING THE BRUTAL KILLING OF DR. SONATRIA D. GASPAR, ASSISTANT SCHOOLS DIVISION SUPERINTENDENT OF THE MINISTRY OF BASIC, HIGHER AND TECHNICAL EDUCATION OF SULU PROVINCE, AND URGING THE RELEVANT AUTHORITIES TO CONDUCT A JUST, SPEEDY, AND TRANSPARENT INVESTIGATION INTO THE INCIDENT

WHEREAS, Article II, Section 5 of the 1987 Philippine Constitution emphasizes the State's obligation to maintain peace and order, protect life, liberty, and property, and promote the rule of law;

WHEREAS, Article IV of Republic Act No. 11054, otherwise known as the *"Organic Law for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (OLBARMM)"*, affirms the Bangsamoro Government's commitment to peace, justice, and the fundamental rights of the people;

WHEREAS, Article XIV, Section 3 of the 1987 Philippine Constitution recognizes the role of education in fostering patriotism, nationalism, and the total development of individuals and communities, emphasizing the importance of protecting educators who serve as pillars of knowledge, peace, and progress;

WHEREAS, Dr. Sonatria D. Gaspar, Assistant Schools Division Superintendent of the Province of Sulu, was a dedicated public servant committed to advancing education and improving the lives of the people of Sulu and the broader Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM);

WHEREAS, on February 7, 2025, Dr. Gaspar was killed by several gunshots in the head while inside her office at Barangay San Raymundo in Jolo, Sulu;

WHEREAS, such acts of violence against public officials and educators create an atmosphere of fear and intimidation, hindering the flow of essential public services and the pursuit of peace and development in the BARMM;

WHEREAS, the killing of Dr. Gaspar undermines the efforts of the BARMM to promote stability, development, and moral governance, particularly in the education sector;

WHEREAS, the perpetrators of this heinous crime should be swiftly brought to justice to ensure that such acts are not repeated in the BARMM;

WHEREAS, the OLBARMM establishes the Bangsamoro Government as a vehicle for lasting peace, social justice, and inclusive development, and explicitly mandates the protection of human rights, the promotion of moral governance, and the eradication of all forms of injustice and violence;

WHEREAS, the Bangsamoro Transition Authority Parliament extends its deepest condolences to Dr. Gaspar's family, colleagues, and the entire academic community of Sulu:

NOW, THEREFORE, be it

RESOLVED, as it is hereby resolved by the Bangsamoro Transition Authority Parliament, To strongly condemn the killing of Dr. Sonatria D. Gaspar, Assistant Schools Division Superintendent of the Ministry of Basic, Higher and Technical Education of Sulu Province, and urging the relevant authorities to conduct a just, speedy, and transparent investigation into the incident.

RESOLVED, FURTHER, To call upon the relevant authorities, including the Bangsamoro Government, the Police Regional Office - Bangsamoro Autonomous Region, and the National Bureau of Investigation (NBI), to immediately conduct a thorough, impartial, and expeditious investigation into the killing of Dr. Gaspar, in accordance with the principles of justice and accountability enshrined in the 1987 Philippine Constitution and the OLBARMM.

RESOLVED, FURTHERMORE, To urge the Bangsamoro Government and the National Government to provide adequate protection for public officials, educators, and community leaders who are at risk of violence due to their work in promoting peace, development, and moral governance.

RESOLVED, FURTHERMORE, To call upon all sectors of society, including civil society organizations, religious leaders, and local communities, to cooperate fully with the investigation and to support efforts to uphold justice and the rule of law, as envisioned in the 1987 Philippine Constitution and the OLBARMM.

RESOLVED, FINALLY, To furnish this Resolution to the Ministry of Basic, Higher and Technical Education, the Ministry of the Interior and Local Government, the Philippine National Police, the Director of the National Bureau of Investigation, and other relevant authorities, for immediate action.

ADOPTED, *Sha'ban* 12, 1446/February 11, 2025.

Certified Correct:

PROF. RABY B. ANGKAL
Secretary-General

Attested:

ATTY. PANGALIAN M. BALINDONG
Speaker

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